

Q How have you differentiated yourselves from players like Rackspace, or other Indian players?

A. Data centre players in India fall under different categories. There are standalone data centre players that provide only co-location services, which means that they sell power, cooling and space only. Then there are data centres owned by the telecom players that are leveraging the advantage of bandwidth connectivity (so the DC business naturally complements what they do), and then there are managed service providers. By and large, ESDS falls into the third category of data centres in India providing managed services.

The differentiation that ESDS provides is the expertise in offering customised solutions as against standard product offerings. ESDS believes in innovation and has its own R&D team that is CMMI 3 certified. The team has developed quite a few great data centre related products that are used by major enterprises in India today. Our biggest differentiator is a unique auto-scaling cloud solution called eNlight, which is combined with pay-per-consume billing. eNlight has a patent from the USPTO (United States Patent and Trademark Office) for auto scaling of resources in real-time. Compared to Rackspace, we offer vertical real-time scaling and a pay-per-consume billing mode, which are clear differentiators. Our eNlight 360 provides users the power to manage various diverse hypervisors from a single control panel.

Q Does ESDS provide anything like a platform-as-a-service or are you at the purely data centre level?

A. Currently, we are a big time IaaS provider while we do provide certain software on the SaaS model. We have recently launched an e-commerce platform that we provide as a service but, going forward, we will be focusing on providing various types of PaaS.

Q ESDS has a US patent for the methods it uses for resource allotment and requirements or, in other words, for auto scalability. Can you tell us more about what this is all about?

A. A virtual machine (VM) is a typical instance of IaaS, which consists of the CPU, RAM, the network, the disk and operating system with optional preinstalled applications. The patent is for the method and system for detecting, in real-time, the resource requirements of a system in a virtual environment and automatically scaling resource parameters according to these requirements. The virtual machine controller constantly measures resource utilisation in the servers and virtual machines associated with it. If a resource requirement is detected with any virtual machine, the automatic resource scaling system detects the type of resource to be scaled, and scales the selected resource. Further, the resource may be scaled up or scaled down, based on the requirements. The scaled resource could be the CPU, RAM, disk or any such resource. This system helps to save space and power without compromising security, performance and accessibility.

Q How does having such a patent impact the growth of a business?

A. The patented technology does help as a key enabler for an organisation's growth. We are accustomed to always following the 'big brothers' in technology, but when you have a patent from the United States for a unique product, it helps local enterprises to develop faith in products that are made in India. It also becomes a clear differentiator regarding an organisation's strength in technology as compared to other providers, and it shows our commitment to innovate unique solutions to help businesses, which in turn helps in the nation's growth.

Q Where is your main data centre located?

A. Our Uptime Institute certified Tier 3 data centre is located at Mahape in Navi Mumbai and our head office, along with our Tier 3 data centre, is situated in the heart of Nashik.

Q What would you say is the key factor driving this group?

A. A passion for continuous innovation and the trust of each single employee in our vision of creating lifetime customer relationships (by providing cloud enabled solutions and managed data centre services) are the two key factors driving the group.

Q Then the challenge is more about proving to be a better option as compared to the competitors, rather than having to sell the concept?

A. We do not believe in or focus on proving ourselves as a better option. We believe in continuous innovation rather than competing. Competition is about getting better, centered across something similar, while our goal is to give the world niche, cost-effective technology solutions. We come up with solutions that fill the gap, and serve to eliminate the pain areas of our technology, thereby eliminating the need to sell any concept that might or might not take off.

Q And how much is the business and revenue from international clients?

A. Revenue from Indian clients has crossed US\$ 6 million, while revenue from our international clients is more than US\$ 12 million.

Q Has the recent rule from the government of India to have more data centres located within India, particularly those related to the government, benefited you in any way?

A. Currently, the government is working on empanelling Indian data centres for government institutions to host their applications and data. Once this is done, government organisations and PSUs would no longer be required to host their data at the state data centres, and this will definitely benefit private data centre players.